

Section 3.2 Matters of life and death

Students will be required to: demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specification; express their own responses to the issues and questions raised by the specification using reasons and evidence; evaluate alternative points of view about these issues and questions.

Key words — abortion, assisted suicide, euthanasia, immortality of the soul, near-death experience, non-voluntary euthanasia, paranormal, quality of life, reincarnation, resurrection, sanctity of life, voluntary euthanasia

- Why Roman Catholics believe in life after death and how beliefs about life after death affect their lives.
- Non-religious reasons for believing in life after death (near-death experiences, ghosts, mediums, evidence of reincarnation).
- Why some people do not believe in life after death.
- The nature of abortion, including current British legislation, and why abortion is a controversial issue.
- Different Christian attitudes to abortion and the reasons for them.
- The nature of euthanasia including current British legislation, and why euthanasia is a controversial issue.
- Christian attitudes to euthanasia and the reasons for them.
- Arguments for and against the media being free to criticise what religions say about matters of life and death.
- The causes of world poverty.
- How and why CAFOD (Catholic Agency for Overseas Development) is trying to end world poverty.
- How an issue arising from matters of life and death has been presented in one form of the media, for example in a television or radio programme, or in a film, or in the national press; including whether the treatment was fair to religious beliefs and religious people.